

**LISTENING**
#29**Teacher's Guide****SCRIPT: COFFEE-POWERED BUSES**

Presenter: Now many of us with busy jobs run on coffee. But could that work for buses? One British entrepreneur thinks so. He wants the famous red buses in London to be run on biofuel made from coffee waste. But why coffee? I asked our technology reporter, Jane Waitsfield.

Waitsfield: It is widely drunk. I mean there is a coffee shop, it seems, on every street these days. And it creates a degree of waste, which is obviously then of no use to the coffee shops but can be used to make biofuels through, which is increasingly being seen as a clean alternative to fossil fuels.

Presenter: And it could also help combat pollution.

Waitsfield: Indeed, yes. And in London we have an especially sort of a big problem with pollution. Cities around the world are looking for greener ways to bring down the levels of pollution, get rid of fossil fuels and turn them into things like biofuels for that.

And in London, this entrepreneur who runs a company called Biobean has done lots of deals with coffee chains and has got a factory in the UK that is turning this coffee waste into biofuel. And his next plan is to do that with London Bus. The details of that are going to be revealed later this month

Presenter: As you say, there is no shortage of coffee wasted in London. When will we see that first coffee run bus in London?

Waitsfield: So the details are at the end of this month. And I guess that will be an actual real bus run on coffee on the streets.

If you could get enough coffee waste, and we do apparently drink 500,000 tonnes of coffee in the UK. And if you could use all of that, all of the waste from that, you could power a city the size of Manchester according to Biobean.

Presenter: It would be interesting to know if there would be an aroma of coffee as you are boarding that bus. It would be quite nice, wouldn't it?

Waitsfield: Wouldn't that be lovely, and so much nicer than petrol fumes.

Presenter: And there has been more of a focus on biofuels made from food waste rather than food itself because you don't then need land to grow it.

Waitsfield: Exactly. A few years ago, there was a big push for biofuels made from crops, but then the question became well you know these crops in some ways you are creating as much problems with that because the crops could be used for feeding people. So increasingly, people are looking to things like coffee and sewage even to make biofuels.

Presenter: Even chocolate.

Waitsfield: Chocolate. Well yes.

Answer Key

Comprehension Activity

1. Coffee waste
2. b) It produces a lot of waste
3. Pollution in London
4. b) Biobean
5. a) Signed deals to collect waste
6. Later this month
7. b) Manchester
8. b) Crops should be used to feed people

Reading Comprehension

1. Air pollution and dependence on fossil fuels.
2. It is thrown away
3. It doesn't require farmland or food resources.

Idioms & Vocabulary

“No shortage of...” = There is plenty / a lot of something

“Breathe a little easier” = An expression meaning life becomes more comfortable or less harmful

Crop = a plant grown on farms to be used as food or raw material

Audio says: “biofuels made from crops...”